

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture Supplement

The rules of the 'Adad and the Ma'dood

1. The basic terms

Term	Definition
عَدَد	the words used for counting — one, two, three
مَعْدُود	the thing being counted — books, pens, men
تَمْيِيز	the noun that removes the vagueness of the number. It is generally Mansoob, though under certain rules it comes as Majroor

- In Arabic all the words of counting are nouns.
- The nouns of number are *Munsarif*, except for certain *Mabni* numbers — that is, all three states of *I'raab* come upon them.

Ma'dood and Tamyeez: The *Ma'dood* of the numbers from 11 to 99 is called in grammatical terms the *Tamyeez Mansoob*, because it removes the vagueness of the number and always comes *Mansoob*.

2. The four kinds of number

By their build, the nouns of number fall into four great groups.

Kind	Range	Definition
Mufrad	1 to 10, also 100 and 1000	a single standing word. The mufrad numbers are twelve in all
Murakkab	11 to 19	numbers formed of two words
'Uqood	20 to 90	the tens
Ma'toof	21 to 99	numbers with the Harf ul 'Atf waw between them

3. The rule for 1 and 2

The construction: These form a *Murakkab Tawsifi* with the *Ma'dood*. The *Ma'dood* comes first as the *Mawsuf*, and the number after it as the *Sifah*. In gender and in *l'raab* the number accords **exactly** with its *Ma'dood*.

Gender	In raf'	In nasb and jarr	Qur'anic example
masculine	قَلَمٌ وَاحِدٌ	قَلَمًا وَاحِدًا . قَلَمٍ وَاحِدٍ	إِلَهُ وَاحِدٌ
feminine	سَاعَةٌ وَاحِدَةٌ	سَاعَةً وَاحِدَةً . سَاعَةٍ وَاحِدَةٍ	نَفْخَةٌ وَاحِدَةٌ
masculine	قَلَمَانِ اثْنَانِ	قَلَمَيْنِ اثْنَيْنِ	رَجُلَيْنِ اثْنَيْنِ
feminine	سَاعَتَانِ اثْنَتَانِ	سَاعَتَيْنِ اثْنَتَيْنِ	امْرَأَتَيْنِ اثْنَتَيْنِ

The benefit of bringing the number: In Arabic a singular noun — such as رَجُلٌ — already carries the sense of "one". What then is gained by bringing وَاحِدٌ? It produces **emphasis and force** in the speech: "one and only one".

About Ithnani: Its hamzah is a *Hamzat ul Wasl*, which is why it falls away when read joined. Its feminine is اِثْنَتَانِ.

4. The rule for 3 to 10

The construction: These form a *Murakkab Idafi* with the *Ma'dood*. The number comes first as the *Mudaf*, and the *Ma'dood* after it as the *Mudaf Ilayh*.

The condition of the *Ma'dood*: from 3 to 10 it is always plural and Nakirah, and being the *Mudaf Ilayh* it is always Majroor.

The opposition of gender — the most important rule

Rule: The gender of the number and of the *Ma'dood* are the reverse of one another.

- If the *Ma'dood* is masculine, the number comes feminine — that is, with the round taa'.
- If the *Ma'dood* is feminine, the number comes masculine — that is, without the round taa'.

Examples

Meaning	Arabic	Explanation
three men	ثَلَاثَةُ رِجَالٍ	"man" is masculine, so the number came feminine
three women	ثَلَاثُ نِسَاءٍ	"women" is feminine, so the number came masculine
six days	سِتَّةَ أَيَّامٍ	"day" is masculine, so the number came feminine
seven nights	سَبْعَ لَيَالٍ	"night" is feminine, so the number came masculine

All three states: ثَلَاثَةُ رِجَالٍ in *raf'*, ثَلَاثَةُ رِجَالٍ in *nasb*, ثَلَاثَةُ رِجَالٍ in *jarr* — and the *Ma'dood* stayed *Majroor* in every one of them.

Examples from the Qur'an

اللَّهُ الَّذِي خَلَقَ السَّمُوتِ وَالْأَرْضَ وَمَا بَيْنَهُمَا فِي سِتَّةِ أَيَّامٍ ثُمَّ اسْتَوَى عَلَى الْعَرْشِ

(Surah as-Sajdah: 4)

Translation: Allah is He who created the heavens and the earth and whatever is between them in six days, then established Himself above the Throne.

سَخَّرَهَا عَلَيْهِمْ سَبْعَ لَيَالٍ وَثَمَنِيَةَ أَيَّامٍ حُسُومًا

(Surah al-Haqqah: 7)

Translation: He imposed it upon them for seven nights and eight days in succession.

In this one verse both rules appear together: in **سَبْعَ لَيَالٍ** "night" is feminine so the number is masculine, and in **ثُمَّنِيَّةَ أَيَّامٍ** "day" is masculine so the number is feminine.

An exception

The exception: The numbers 3 to 10 are sometimes used in the Qur'an as a *Murakkab Tawsifi* as well, as in **السَّمُوتِ السَّبْعِ**. Here the *Ma'dood* comes first and becomes *Ma'rifah*, yet **the rule of the opposition of gender still holds**.

A fine point: In an ordinary *Murakkab Tawsifi* the *Sifah* and *Mawsuf* share one gender. Yet here, despite the opposition, it is still reckoned a *Murakkab Tawsifi* — because the numbers have a settled rule of their own that prevails over the general one.

5. The rule for 100 and 1000

The construction: These too form a *Murakkab Idafi* with the *Ma'dood* — the number as the *Mudaf* and the *Ma'dood* as the *Mudaf Ilayh*.

- The condition of the *Ma'dood*: it is always **singular and Majroor**; the plural is not brought.
- The rule of gender: these numbers remain **alike** for masculine and feminine *Ma'dood*; their own gender does not change.

Masculine Ma'dood	Feminine Ma'dood
مِائَةٌ رَجُلٍ	مِائَةٌ امْرَأَةٍ
أَلْفُ رَجُلٍ	أَلْفُ امْرَأَةٍ

الرَّانِيَةُ وَالرَّانِي فَاجْلِدُوا كُلَّ وَاحِدٍ مِّنْهُمَا مِائَةَ جَلْدَةٍ

(Surah an-Nur: 2)

Translation: The adulteress and the adulterer — lash each one of them a hundred lashes.

لَيْلَةُ الْقَدْرِ خَيْرٌ مِّنْ أَلْفِ شَهْرٍ

(Surah al-Qadr: 3)

Translation: The Night of Decree is better than a thousand months.

Further forms of Mi'ah and Alf

The hundred and the thousand also have their dual and plural, each with its own rules.

Number	Arabic	Explanation
200	مِائَتَانِ	the dual of مِائَةٌ; as a Mudaf its noon falls: مِائَتَا رَجُلٍ
300 to 900	ثَلَاثُ مِائَةٍ	here مِائَةٌ itself becomes the Mudaf Ilayh and stays singular, not plural
2000	أَلْفَانِ	the dual of أَلْفٍ
3000 to 10000	ثَلَاثَةُ أَلْفٍ	here the plural of أَلْفٍ, ألف, comes, and the rule of 3 to 10 applies

وَلَبِثُوا فِي كَهْفِهِمْ ثَلَاثَ مِائَةٍ سِنِينَ وَارْدَادُوا تِسْعًا

(Surah al-Kahf: 25)

Translation: And they remained in their cave three hundred years, and exceeded by nine.

Here in ثَلَاثَ مِائَةٍ the word مِائَةٍ is singular and *Majroor*, not plural.

أَنْ يُمِدَّكُمْ رَبُّكُمْ بِثَلَاثَةِ أَلْفٍ مِّنَ الْمَلَائِكَةِ مُنَزَّلِينَ

(Surah Al 'Imran: 124)

Translation: That your Lord should reinforce you with three thousand angels sent down.

Here in ثَلَاثَةِ أَلْفٍ the plural of أَلْف has come, and since أَلْف is masculine the number came feminine — the very rule of 3 to 10.

6. The numbers 11 to 19 — the compound numbers

These numbers consist of two parts, a first and a second.

The condition of the Ma'dood — 11 to 99: For all the numbers from 11 to 99 the *Ma'dood* is always singular, Nakirah and Mansoob.

The rule of l'raab: Apart from the number 12, both parts of every number from 11 to 19 are *Mabni 'ala al-Fath* — that is, a fathah stays on both parts, whatever place the word holds in the sentence.

6.1 With a masculine Ma'dood

Number	Arabic	The rule
11	أَحَدَ عَشَرَ طَالِبًا	agreement — both parts masculine, matching the Ma'dood
12	إِثْنًا عَشَرَ طَالِبًا	agreement — the noon of إِثْنَانٍ fell because of the Mudaf-like build
13	ثَلَاثَةَ عَشَرَ طَالِبًا	opposition — the first part feminine and the second masculine, matching the Ma'dood

6.2 With a feminine Ma'dood

Number	Arabic	The rule
11	إِحْدَى عَشْرَةَ طَالِبَةً	agreement — both parts feminine, matching the Ma'dood
12	إِثْنَتَا عَشْرَةَ طَالِبَةً	agreement — both feminine
13	ثَلَاثَ عَشْرَةَ طَالِبَةً	opposition — the first part masculine and the second feminine, matching the Ma'dood

In short: In 11 and 12 both parts agree; from 13 to 19 the first part is opposite and the second agrees.

6.3 The particular rule of the number 12

Rule: The first part of the number 12 is *Mu'rab* and its l'raab changes like that of the dual, while the second part stays *Mabni*.

State	Masculine	Feminine
raf'	إِثْنَا عَشَرَ	إِثْنَتَا عَشْرَةَ

State	Masculine	Feminine
nasb and jarr	اِثْنِي عَشَرَ	اِثْنَتِي عَشْرَةَ

فَانْفَجَرَتْ مِنْهُ اثْنَتَا عَشْرَةَ عَيْنًا قَدْ عَلِمَ كُلُّ اُنَاسٍ مَّشْرَبَهُمْ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 60)

Translation: And there gushed forth from it twelve springs. Every people knew its drinking place.

Here اِثْنَتَا عَشْرَةَ is in the state of *raf'*, and the *Ma'dood* عَيْنًا is singular, *Nakirah* and *Mansoob*.

An example in *nasb*: رَأَيْتُ اِثْنَتِي عَشْرَةَ عَيْنًا.

7. The 'Uqood — the tens, 20 to 90

عِشْرُونَ • ثَلَاثُونَ • أَرْبَعُونَ • خَمْسُونَ
سِتُّونَ • سَبْعُونَ • ثَمَانُونَ • تِسْعُونَ

- The rule of gender: these words stay **alike** for both masculine and feminine *Ma'dood*; no change of gender occurs in them.
- The *Ma'dood*: singular, *Nakirah* and *Mansoob*.

The rule of I'raab: Their I'raab is like that of the *Jam' Salim Mudhakkar*: in *raf'* with a waw and noon, عِشْرُونَ; and in *nasb* and *jarr* with a yaa' and noon, عِشْرَيْنَ.

8. The Ma'toof numbers — 21 to 99

This is the fourth kind named in the division. Its rules follow.

The order: In Arabic the unit comes first, then the *Harf ul 'Atf* waw, then the ten — the reverse of English. "Twenty-one" is said in Arabic as "one and twenty".

وَاحِدٌ وَعِشْرُونَ

(twenty-one — literally "one and twenty")

Three rules

- The unit follows the rule of 1 to 9 — that is, the **opposition of gender** from 3 to 9, and agreement in 1 and 2.
- The ten stays always the same, and its I'raab changes like that of the *Jam' Salim Mudhakkar*.
- The *Ma'dood* remains singular, *Nakirah* and *Mansoob* as before.

Number	Arabic	Explanation
21 boys	أَحَدٌ وَعِشْرُونَ طَالِبًا	the unit masculine, matching the Ma'dood
21 girls	إِحْدَى وَعِشْرُونَ طَالِبَةً	the unit feminine, matching the Ma'dood
23 boys	ثَلَاثَةٌ وَعِشْرُونَ طَالِبًا	the Ma'dood masculine, so the unit feminine — opposition
23 girls	ثَلَاثٌ وَعِشْرُونَ طَالِبَةً	the Ma'dood feminine, so the unit masculine — opposition

Examples from the Qur'an

إِنَّ هَذَا أَخِي لَهُ تِسْعٌ وَتِسْعُونَ نَعَجَةً وَلِي نَعَجَةٌ وَاحِدَةٌ

(Surah Sad: 23)

Translation: Indeed this is my brother; he has ninety-nine ewes and I have one ewe.

Here تِسْعٌ وَتِسْعُونَ is a *Ma'toof* number. The *Ma'dood* نَعَجَةٌ is feminine, so the unit came masculine — the same rule of the opposition of gender. And in the same verse نَعَجَةٌ وَاحِدَةٌ shows the rule of agreement for the number 1.

وَلَقَدْ أَرْسَلْنَا نُوحًا إِلَىٰ قَوْمِهِ فَلَبِثَ فِيهِمْ أَلْفَ سَنَةٍ إِلَّا خَمْسِينَ عَامًا

(Surah al-'Ankabut: 14)

Translation: And We certainly sent Nuh to his people, and he remained among them a thousand years save fifty.

Both rules stand together in this verse: in أَلْفَ سَنَةٍ the *Ma'dood* is singular and *Majroor*, while in خَمْسِينَ عَامًا with the *'Uqood* the *Ma'dood* is singular and *Mansoob*.

9. The ordinal numbers — first, second, third

Definition: All the numbers studied so far were '*Adad Asli*, the cardinal numbers that state a count. Against them stand the '*Adad Tarteebi*, the ordinals, which state order and rank — first, second, third.

Order	Masculine	Feminine
first	أَوَّل	أُولَى
second	ثَانِي	ثَانِيَّة
third	ثَالِث	ثَالِثَة
fourth	رَابِع	رَابِعَة
tenth	عَاشِر	عَاشِرَة

Their rule: The ordinals always form a *Murakkab Tawsifi* — the *Ma'dood* as the *Mawsuf* and the number as the *Sifah*. And they hold full agreement in all four aspects: gender, number, *wus'at* and *I'raab*. Here the rule of the opposition of gender does not apply at all.

الطَّالِبُ الثَّالِثُ (the third student) · الطَّالِبَةُ الثَّالِثَةُ (the third female student)

Examples from the Qur'an

إِذْ أَخْرَجَهُ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا ثَانِي اثْنَيْنِ إِذْ هُمَا فِي الْغَارِ

(Surah at-Tawbah: 40)

Translation: When those who disbelieved drove him out, the second of two, when they were both in the cave.

This recalls the Hijrah, when the Prophet, peace be upon him, and Abu Bakr, may Allah be pleased with him, were in the cave of Thawr. ثَانِي اثْنَيْنِ means "the second of two".

لَقَدْ كَفَرَ الَّذِينَ قَالُوا إِنَّ اللَّهَ ثَالِثُ ثَلَاثَةٍ. وَمَا مِنْ إِلَهٍ إِلَّا إِلَهٌ وَاحِدٌ

(Surah al-Ma'idah: 73)

Translation: They have certainly disbelieved who say that Allah is the third of three. And there is no god except one God.

Here in ثَالِثُ ثَلَاثَةٍ an ordinal and a cardinal have come together. And at the end of the verse إِلَهٌ وَاحِدٌ shows the rule of agreement for the number 1.

10. All the rules at a glance

Range	The construction	State of the Ma'dood	Rule of gender
1 to 2	Murakkab Tawsifi	as the number, so the Ma'dood	full agreement
3 to 10	Murakkab Idafi	plural, Nakirah, Majroor	opposite gender
11 to 12	compound, Mabni 'ala al-Fath	singular, Nakirah, Mansoob	both parts agree
13 to 19	compound, Mabni 'ala al-Fath	singular, Nakirah, Mansoob	first part opposite, second agrees
20 to 90	mufrad 'Uqood	singular, Nakirah, Mansoob	alike for masculine and feminine
21 to 99	Ma'toof	singular, Nakirah, Mansoob	the unit follows the rule of 1 to 9
100 and 1000	Murakkab Idafi	singular, Nakirah, Majroor	alike for masculine and feminine
ordinals	Murakkab Tawsifi	the Ma'dood is the Mawsuf	full agreement

Three key points to remember

- The *Ma'dood* is plural only from 3 to 10; everywhere else it is singular.
- The *Ma'dood* is Majroor in only two places: from 3 to 10, and with 100 and 1000 — that is, wherever a *Murakkab Idafi* is formed. From 11 to 99 it is everywhere Mansoob.
- The opposition of gender occurs only from 3 to 10 and in the first part of 13 to 19. In 1, 2, 11, 12 and the ordinals there is agreement, and in the *'Uqood*, the hundred and the thousand no difference is made at all.

Summary

1. The words of counting are the 'Adad and the thing counted the Ma'dood.
2. The noun that removes the vagueness of a number is called the Tamyeez in grammar.
3. In Arabic all the words of counting are nouns, and they are Munsarif except for certain Mabni numbers.
4. The nouns of number are of four kinds: Mufrad, Murakkab, 'Uqood and Ma'toof.
5. The numbers 1 and 2 form a Murakkab Tawsifi with the Ma'dood, the Ma'dood being the Mawsuf and the number the Sifah.
6. In these there is full agreement of gender and of I'raab.
7. A singular noun already carries the sense of one, so bringing وَاحِدٌ serves for emphasis and force.
8. The hamzah of اِثْنَانٍ is a Hamzat ul Wasl, and its feminine is اِثْنَتَانٍ.
9. The numbers 3 to 10 form a Murakkab Idafi, the number being the Mudaf and the Ma'dood the Mudaf Ilayh.
10. Their Ma'dood is always plural, Nakirah and Majroor.
11. The most important rule is the opposition of gender: a masculine Ma'dood takes a feminine number, and a feminine Ma'dood a masculine number.
12. In سَبْعَ لَيَالٍ وَثَمَنِيَةَ أَيَّامٍ both rules appear together.
13. Sometimes 3 to 10 come as a Murakkab Tawsifi, as in السَّمُوتِ السَّبْعِ, yet the rule of opposition still holds.
14. 100 and 1000 also form a Murakkab Idafi, but their Ma'dood is singular and Majroor, never plural.
15. Both these numbers stay alike for masculine and feminine.
16. For 200 there is مِائَتَانِ, and from 300 to 900 مِائَةٌ itself becomes the Mudaf Ilayh and stays singular.
17. From 3000 to 10000 the plural أَلْفٌ comes, and the rule of 3 to 10 applies.
18. From 11 to 99 the Ma'dood of every number is always singular, Nakirah and Mansoob.
19. Apart from 12, both parts of every number from 11 to 19 are Mabni 'ala al-Fath.
20. In 11 and 12 both parts agree with the Ma'dood; from 13 to 19 the first part is opposite and the second agrees.
21. The first part of 12 is Mu'rab and changes like the dual: اِثْنَا in raf' and اِثْنَي in nasb and jarr.
22. The 'Uqood, 20 to 90, are alike for masculine and feminine, and their I'raab changes like the Jam' Salim Mudhakkar.
23. In the Ma'toof numbers the unit comes first, then the waw, then the ten — the reverse of English.
24. In these the unit follows the rule of 1 to 9, and the Ma'dood stays singular, Nakirah and Mansoob.
25. The ordinals always form a Murakkab Tawsifi and hold full agreement in all four aspects.
26. The Ma'dood is plural only from 3 to 10; everywhere else it is singular.
27. The Ma'dood is Majroor only where a Murakkab Idafi is formed, that is, from 3 to 10 and with 100 and 1000.

28. The opposition of gender occurs only from 3 to 10 and in the first part of 13 to 19.

Exercise

1. Define the 'Adad, the Ma'dood and the Tamyeez.
 2. Write all four kinds of the nouns of number with their ranges.
 3. Write the rule for the numbers 1 and 2, with masculine and feminine examples.
 4. If a singular noun already carries the sense of one, what is gained by bringing وَاحِدٌ?
 5. Write the construction of 3 to 10 and all three conditions of the Ma'dood.
 6. State the rule of the opposition of gender and give four examples.
 7. Separate both rules in سَبْعَ لَيَالٍ وَثَمَنِينَ أَيَّامٍ.
 8. Explain the exception to the rule of 3 to 10.
 9. How do the rules of 100 and 1000 differ from those of 3 to 10?
 10. Write the rules for the dual and plural of أَلْفٌ and مِائَةٌ.
 11. What is the state of the Ma'dood from 11 to 99?
 12. Form three examples each, masculine and feminine, from 11 to 19.
 13. What is the particular rule of the number 12? Write all four forms.
 14. Analyse فَانْفَجَرَتْ مِنْهُ اثْنَتَا عَشْرَةَ عَيْنًا.
 15. Write the rules of gender and I'raab for the 'Uqood.
 16. Write the order and all three rules of the Ma'toof numbers.
 17. Write "23 boys" and "23 girls" in Arabic and explain the difference.
 18. Take out both numbers from verse 23 of Surah Sad and state their rules.
 19. Separate both states of the Ma'dood in verse 14 of Surah al-'Ankabut.
 20. What is the difference between the 'Adad Asli and the 'Adad Tarteebi?
 21. Analyse ثَالِثُ ثَلَاثَةٍ and ثَانِيِ اثْنَيْنِ.
 22. Set out the table of all the rules.
 23. Write all three key points to remember.
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سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ